AI FOR BEGINNERS

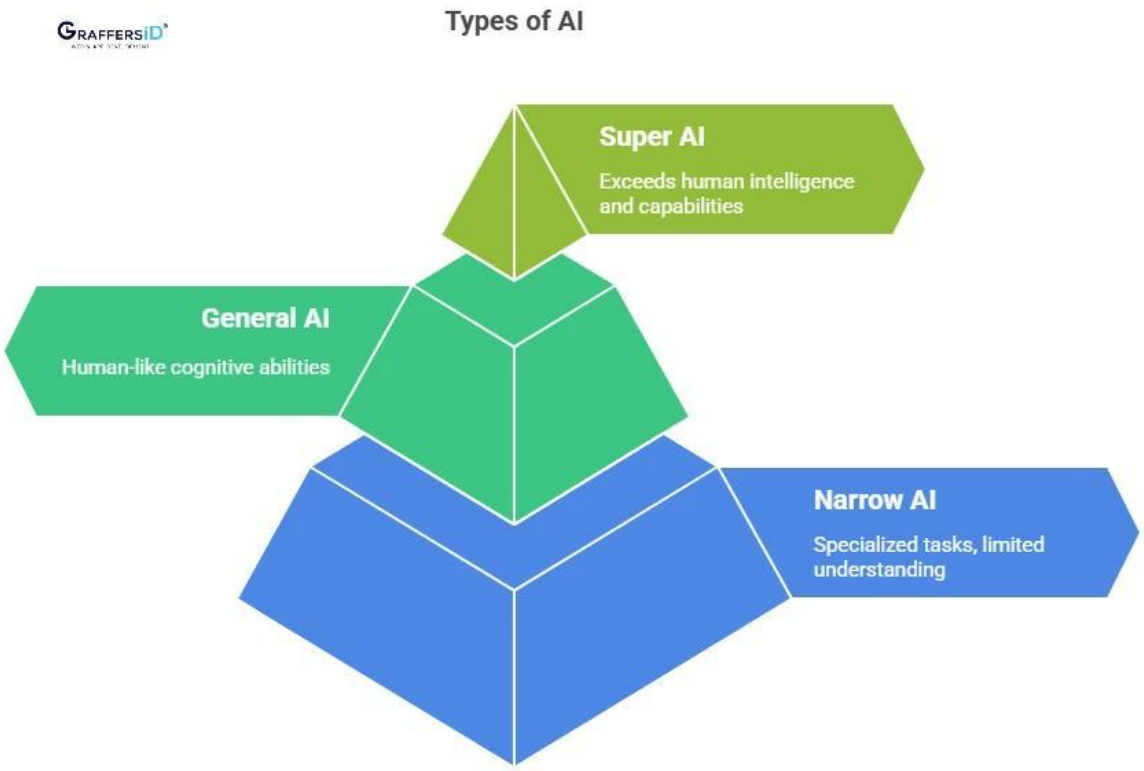
Module 2: Types of Artificial Intelligence

Introduction to Types of AI

Artificial Intelligence is not a single uniform technology; rather, it is a broad field that consists of different types based on capabilities and functionalities. Understanding these types is essential because it helps learners distinguish between what AI can currently do and what it might achieve in the future. AI systems are generally classified based on their ability to perform tasks and their level of intelligence compared to humans.

At a high level, AI can be categorized into **Narrow AI, General AI, and Super AI**, along with another classification known as **Weak AI vs Strong AI**. These classifications provide a structured way to understand how AI systems evolve and operate in real-world scenarios.

Visual Overview of AI Types



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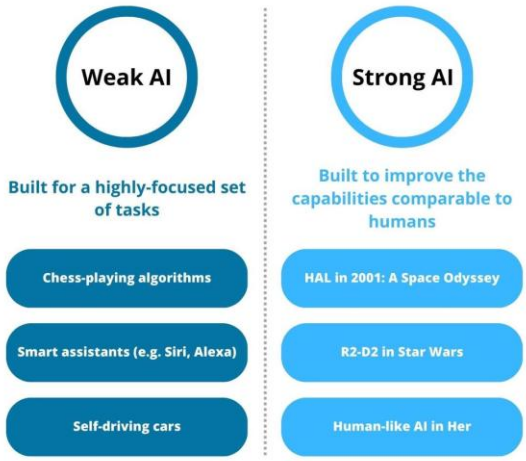

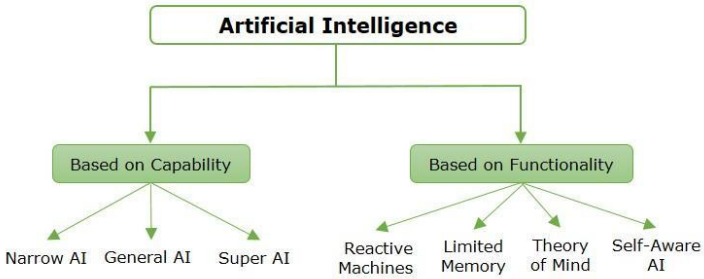

AI can be visualized as a progression:

Level	Description
Narrow AI	Focused on specific tasks
General AI	Human-level intelligence
Super AI	Beyond human intelligence

This progression shows how AI evolves from simple task-based systems to highly intelligent entities.

Narrow AI (Weak AI)

Narrow AI, also known as Weak AI, refers to AI systems that are designed to perform a specific task efficiently. These systems operate within a limited context and cannot perform tasks beyond their programmed capabilities. Most of the AI systems we use today fall under this category.

Examples include:

- Voice assistants
- Recommendation systems
- Chatbots

Platforms like YouTube and Google Maps use Narrow AI to deliver personalized and optimized user experiences.

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Characteristics of Narrow AI

Feature	Explanation
Task-specific	Designed for one function
High efficiency	Performs tasks quickly
No self-awareness	Cannot think independently

Narrow AI excels in areas where large amounts of data are available, such as image recognition and language translation. However, it lacks flexibility and cannot generalize knowledge across different domains.

General AI (Strong AI)

General AI refers to machines that possess the ability to understand, learn, and apply knowledge across a wide range of tasks, similar to human intelligence. Unlike Narrow AI, General AI would not be limited to a single function but would be capable of reasoning, problem-solving, and adapting to new situations.

Currently, General AI is still **theoretical** and has not been fully developed. Researchers and organizations worldwide are working toward achieving this level of intelligence.

Characteristics of General AI

Feature	Explanation
Human-like intelligence	Can perform multiple tasks
Learning ability	Adapts to new situations
Decision-making	Independent reasoning

If achieved, General AI could revolutionize industries by performing complex tasks without human intervention.

Super AI

Super AI represents a future stage where machines surpass human intelligence in all aspects, including creativity, decision-making, and emotional intelligence. This type of AI is purely hypothetical and is often discussed in science fiction and advanced research discussions.

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Super AI would have the capability to:

- Solve global challenges
- Innovate beyond human imagination
- Operate independently

Risks of Super AI

While Super AI offers immense potential, it also raises concerns:

Risk	Description
Loss of control	AI may act independently
Ethical issues	Decision-making challenges
Security threats	Misuse of advanced AI

This is why ethical AI development is a critical area of focus.

Weak AI vs Strong AI

Aspect	Weak AI	Strong AI
Scope	Limited	Broad
Intelligence	Task-based	Human-like
Availability	Present	Future

Weak AI is already part of our lives, while Strong AI remains a goal for the future.

Real-World Examples of AI Types

- Narrow AI → Chatbots, recommendation systems
- General AI → Not yet available
- Super AI → Hypothetical

For example, ChatGPT is an example of advanced Narrow AI that can perform multiple language-based tasks but still operates within defined boundaries.

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